

Introduce yourself to a person sitting in front, behind or beside you.

What have you found in your secondary research that is interesting, surprising or confusing?

## **Pair & Share**

### Insights from secondary research

WAVE?

DESIGN THINKING

REDESIGNING DESIGN

DESIGNING SOCIETY

INTRO

How?

GETTING UNDER YOUR SKIN

3 SPACES OF INNOVATION

THE PROJECT & THE BRIEF

SMART TEAMS

THE INNOVATION ENVIRONMENT

BUILDING TO THINK

A MENTAL MATRIX

CONVERTING NEED INTO DEMAND

INTRO

ELEMENTS OF DESIGN THINKING

PREVAILING CONDITIONS

INTEGRATIVE THINKING

TOOLS

WHAT IS A PROTOTYPE?

TYPING ORGANIZATIONS

INSPIRATION

EMPATHY

BACK INSP



CPICOS 000076A

We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities – past, present, and emerging – of the lands that the University of Sydney's campuses stand on. For thousands of years they have shared and exchanged knowledges across innumerable generations for the benefit of all.



# Overview: Week 3

- Design Thinking concepts & theory
- Design Thinking methods & practice
- A3 sample
- Wrap Up



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- **Design Thinking** concepts & theory
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## Weekly lecture attendance check

- In-person and online attendance, and recorded lecture views are monitored
- Students who attend or watch lecture recordings have a much better understanding of key concepts, and tutorial and assessment requirements
- No mark penalty but you will receive reminder emails about the importance of lectures

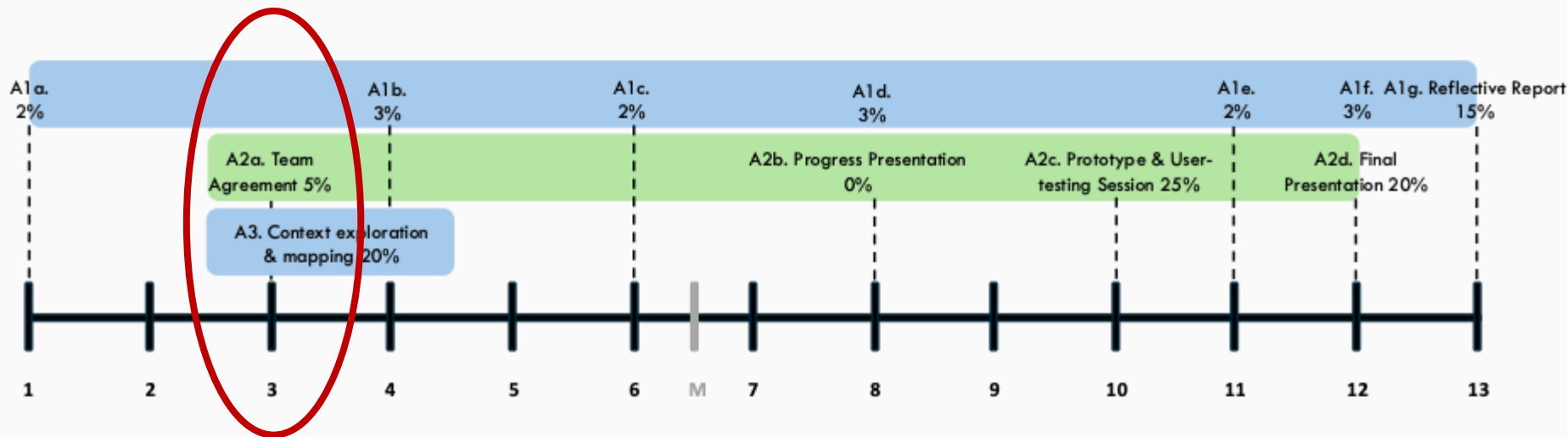


## IDEA9106 Assessments Semester 2 2026

All assessments are mandatory

Questionati is the unit's AI for 24/7 answers to assessment questions

Assessments in this unit are connected, building towards A1 g. And A2d.



MS: Mindset

PE: Peer & Self evaluation

Individual tasks

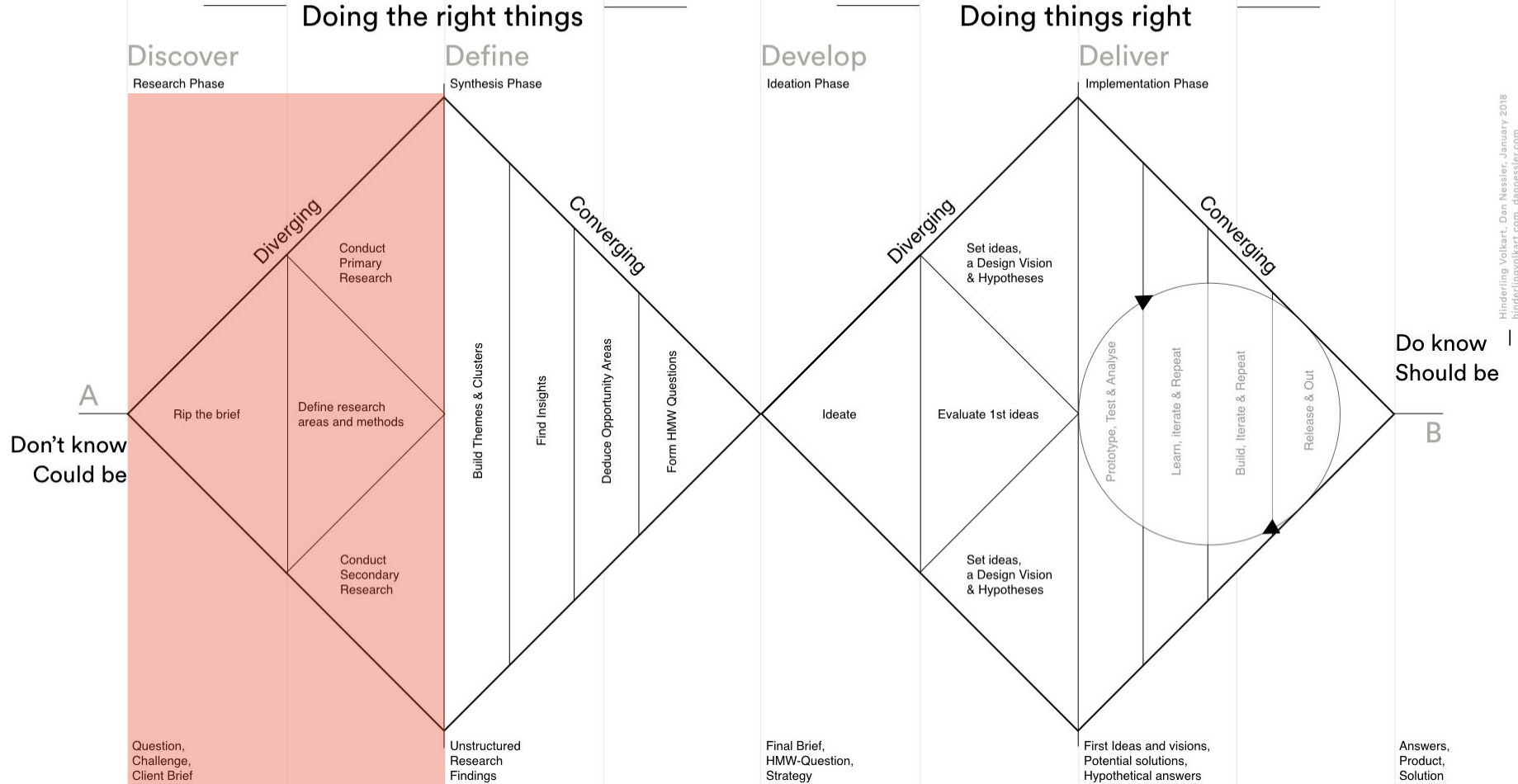
Teamwork tasks

A1: Reflective practice

A2: Collaborative learning

A3: Framing and Reframing

# Revamped Double Diamond



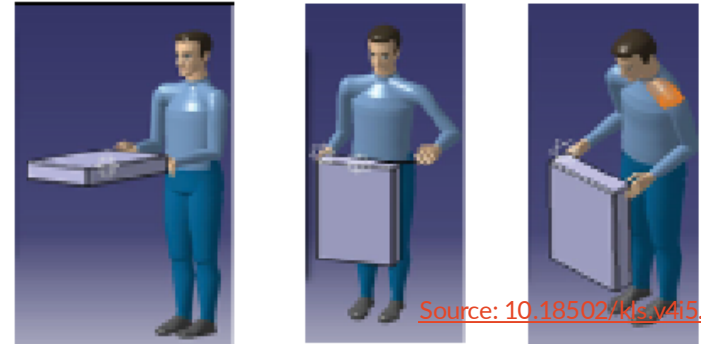


# Manual Milking Workstation

- Tabriz University (2002)
- Industrial design project
- REBA and RULA Posture and Ergonomics Analysis



b) Posture simulation



Source: 10.18502/KIs.v4i5.2551

# Manual Milking Workstation

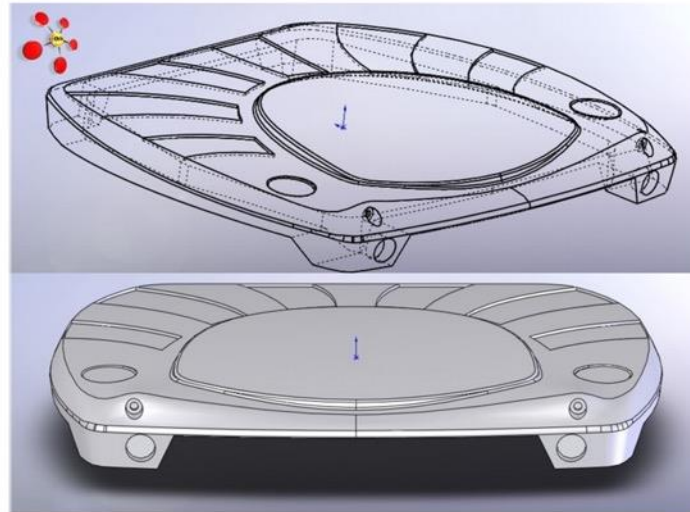
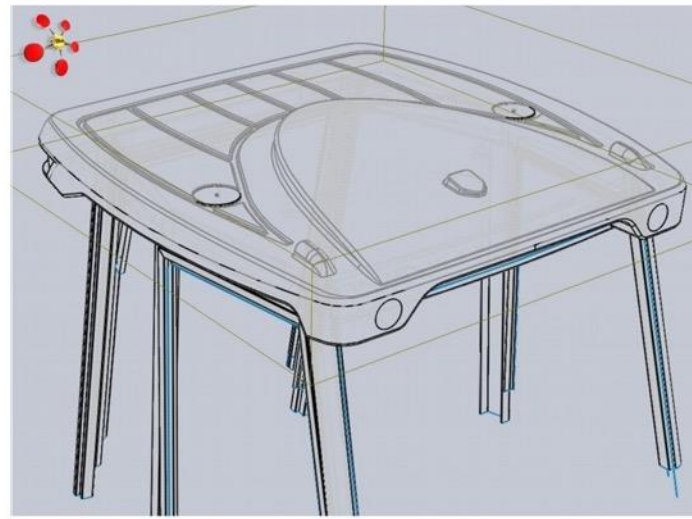
- Tabriz University
- Industrial design
- REBA and RULA

The staff:  
“It’s all about the  
smell”



# Ovan Backhoe Loader

- ITIM Co (2005)
- Driver Cabin Design





## Ovan Backhoe Loader

A man with dark hair, wearing a light blue button-down shirt and dark trousers, is seated in the operator's cab of a white backhoe loader. He is looking out the front window towards the right. The cab has large windows and side mirrors. The background shows a dirt mound.

The operator:  
“I use sound and  
vibration to know  
what’s going on.”



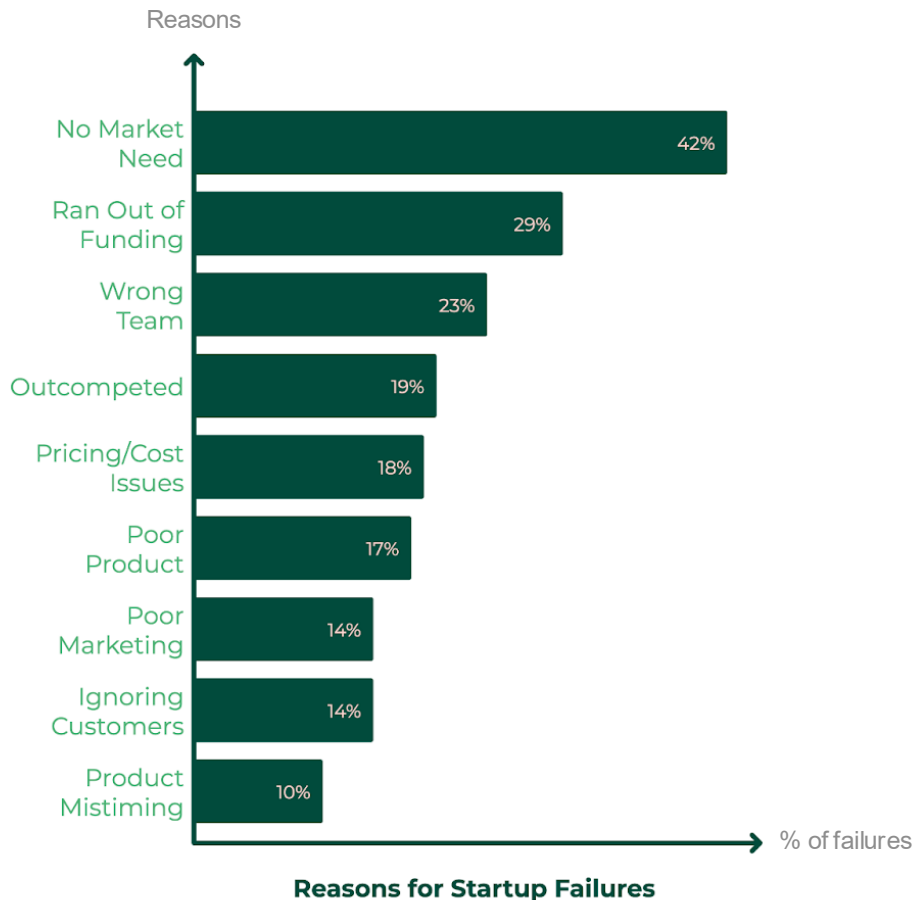
Photo by Quan Jing on Unsplash

# Empathise

Empathy means understanding how someone else feels. In design, it helps us create things that really work for people by imagining their experiences.

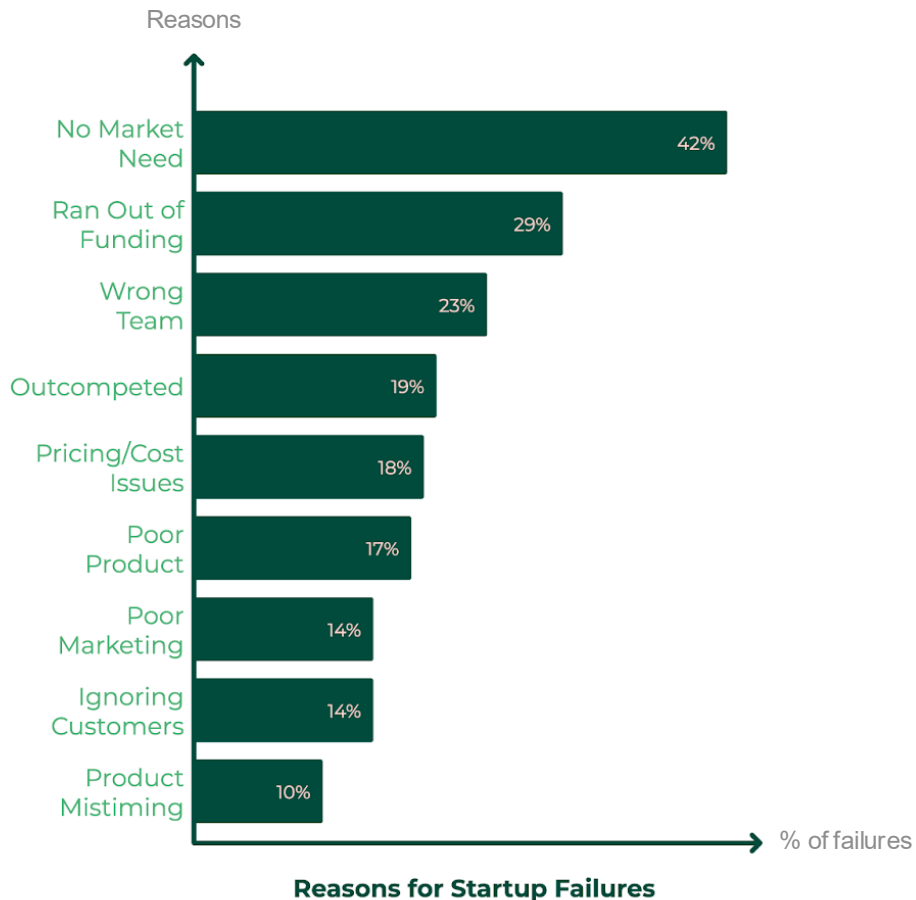
**70% to 80% of new product development that fails does so not for lack of advanced technology, but because of a failure to understand users' needs**

Von Hippel 2007 (MIT Business School)



# Why Startups fail

1. No Market Need (42%)  
Creating a product that doesn't solve a real problem for customers.
2. Poor Product (17%)  
User-unfriendly products that don't meet customer expectations
3. Ignoring Customers (14%)  
Not listening to customer feedback



# Ignoring customers

“We spent way too much time building it for ourselves and not getting feedback from prospects — it’s easy to get tunnel vision...”

“We didn’t spend enough time talking with customers and were rolling out features that I thought were great, but we didn’t gather enough input from clients. We didn’t realise it until it was too late...”







# Quantitative



# Qualitative



| <b>Quantitative research</b> | <b>Qualitative research</b>      |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Test hypotheses              | Formulate hypotheses             |
| Expressed in numbers         | Expresses in words               |
| Larger sample size           | Smaller sample size              |
| Statistical analysis         | Summarise, categorise, interpret |





# Quantitative Questionnaires Surveys



**Qualitative**  
Interviews  
Observations  
Artefacts

## Quantitative Methods



## Qualitative Methods





| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Provides demographic data</li><li>- Data can be expressed in numbers</li><li>- Often employ automated methods</li><li>- Sample size has statistical significance</li></ul>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Describes qualities or characteristics</li><li>- Details about human behavior/emotion</li><li>- Inspiring data for product design</li><li>- Fit between product and user's life</li></ul>       |
| Quan.                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Qual.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Difficult to interpret what it means</li><li>- Doesn't reveal the reasons "why"</li><li>- Encourage over-reliance on facts</li><li>- False correlations can be made</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Data is not factual or numerical</li><li>- Research methods are time-consuming</li><li>- Requires skill to recognise important data</li><li>- More subjectivity on part of researcher</li></ul> |
| Cons                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

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## Interviews



## Types

- Structured
- Semi-structured
- Unstructured



## Preparation

- Decide on the direction of the interview
- Choose your user group and find suitable participants
- Prepare questions  
Write a script  
Open v closed questions
- Pilot/Test questions





## Material

- Consent forms
- Interview script
- Recording equipment (audio)
- Paper, pens
- Camera



## Do ...

- ask open-ended questions, starting with 'How', 'Why', 'What', 'When' or 'Where'



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- ask open-ended questions, starting with 'How', 'Why', 'What', 'When' or 'Where'
- ask for concrete examples, such as "tell me about the last time you ..."





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- repeat and/or reformulate questions for clarity, if needed



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- ask open-ended questions, starting with 'How', 'Why', 'What', 'When' or 'Where'
- ask for concrete examples, such as "tell me about the last time you ..."
- repeat and/or reformulate questions for clarity, if needed
- enquire about problems understanding questions

Adapted from John Lassen, How to Write Effective Qualitative Interview Questions, December 21, 2021, <https://uxmastery.com/how-to-write-effective-qualitative-interview-questions/>





## Don't ...

- ask leading questions



## Don't ...

- ask leading questions
- ask speculative questions like “what would you do...”



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- ask leading questions
- ask speculative questions like “what would you do...”
- ask vague questions so participants have to guess what you mean





## Don't ...

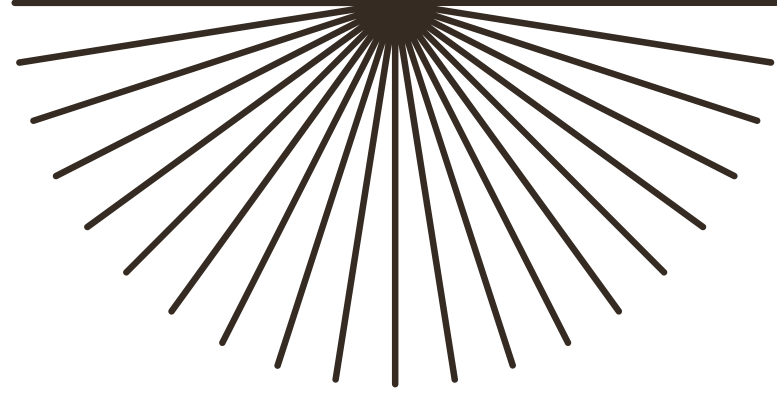
- ask leading questions
- ask speculative questions like “what would you do...”
- ask vague questions so participants have to guess what you mean
- ask questions where participants don't know the context

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# ASSIGNMENT 1

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HOW MIGHT WE REDUCE COST OF LIVING PRESSURES  
FOR PEOPLE IN AUSTRALIA?



# ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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I acknowledge the use of the AI tools ChatGPT and Grammarly for assisting with grammar and written expression in this report. Furthermore, I have used a template from Canva to assist with the visual aspect of the report.

# INTRODUCTION



## Students

The escalating cost of living in Australia is leading to constant challenges for both domestic and international students. With a total of 4 042 512 students in Australia in 2022, of which 11% are international (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2023), there's no doubt that the higher education system is highly intricate. These international students are predominantly from China, India, Nepal, Colombia, and several other countries, contributing to the broad diversity in Australian universities (Australian Government, 2022).

In 2019, the revenue from international education stood as Australia's largest services export, indicating its global importance. While undergraduate programs constitute 62% of the educational framework, postgraduate coursework and research collectively account for a notable 30% (Universities Australia, 2022).

For domestic students, the government's initiative to subsidise education through the Commonwealth-supported Place (CSP) system eases the financial burden (Playdon, 2023). Tuition fees for undergraduates typically range from AUD 15 000 to AUD 33 000, while postgraduate studies could cost between AUD 14 000 and AUD 37 000 per year (Study Adelaide, 2023). The CSP system, distinctively advantageous for local students, anchors tuition costs and extends the Higher Loan Program (HELP), which consists of HECS-HELP, FEE-HELP, and SA-HELP. These loans shield domestic students from an immediate financial burden while they repay their contributions at a later stage, depending on their future income (Playdon, 2023).

Despite these measures, the financial reality for students in Australia is alarming. Student loan debts have increased due to inflation's relentless march, with annual adjustments that compounds the burden. The recent 7.1% surge in student loan balances marks the largest increase in three decades, underscoring the enduring struggle. This situation prompted criticism from the National Students Union, highlighting the need for a comprehensive review of the system's impact on student's financial well-being (Achenza, 2023).

When considering the combination of academic goals and financial difficulties, the rising cost of living implications on Australia's student population call for both analysis and innovative solutions. In a world where education stands as a pillar for progress, it's crucial to understand and address these financial pressures to ensure everyone has a fair chance at education in the future.

## Home ownership

As inflation rates surge to their highest levels in over three decades, the burden of escalating expenses for housing, energy, and other necessities weighs heavily on Australians. These escalating prices, often beyond individuals' direct control, possess the potential to fundamentally impact the quality of life and overall well-being of people. The trends in home ownership reveal a decline in the home ownership rate from 70% in 2006 to 67% in 2021. To support home buyers, the government offer various financial assistance schemes (Australian Institute of Health and Welfare, 2023).

Moreover, "housing stress" is applied to households spending over 30% of their income on housing costs. Typically, higher-income households can allocate more of their income to housing without facing issues. Therefore, a benchmark of 30/40 is often used, implying that households in the bottom 40% of the income distribution are in housing stress if they spend more than 30% of their income on housing (Parliament of Australia, 2015).

Furthermore, the private rental market has experienced shifts, particularly affecting younger households. The proportion of young Australians renting has increased more sharply compared to older generations. Factors influencing these trends include the rising cost of housing, changing household demographics, population growth, and shifts in family composition. House prices have notably surged, with a mean increase of over 80% in seven years. Changes in family structures, including more single-person and single-parent households, have also impacted home ownership rates. Additionally, population growth, driven by immigration and international students, has increased housing demand and necessitated strategic urban planning (Australian Institute of Health and Welfare, 2023).

## The financial system

According to the Reserve Bank of Australia (2022) the Australian financial system is both resilient and capable of supporting the economy during a challenging period, as interest rates rise to control inflation. Despite banks possessing robust capital and liquid positions with healthy profitability (Reserve Bank of Australia, 2022), Australian consumers are struggling with the challenge of rising inflation. The recent data from the Australian Bureau of Statistics highlights significant price increases in various categories over the past year. Food and non-alcoholic beverages rose by 8%, travel and accommodation surged by 25%, and medical services increased by 6.7%. The 15.5% hike in electricity prices is particularly striking, the largest annual rise since 2013 (McDonald & Leggatt, 2023).

The Reserve Bank of Australia aims for an inflation target of 2 to 3%, making the current levels significantly higher. The escalating costs of living have prompted Australians to reduce spending on essentials, tap into savings, or seek additional income sources (McDonald & Leggatt, 2023). Furthermore, The Australian Bureau of Statistics reported that inflation had reached its highest level in 30 years, with the Consumer Price Index rising by 7.8% in the December quarter of 2022. The Reserve Bank of Australia responded by raising interest rates in an attempt to curb inflation, but this move has sparked concerns about the impact on household finances and economic growth (Leggatt, 2023).



## INTERNATIONAL

- Total: 448 274 (Austrade, 2023)
- China: 131 457 (22%)
- India: 98 434 (16%)
- Nepal: 53 170 (9%)
- Colombia: 29 539 (5%)

→ Philippines, Vietnam, Thailand, Brazil, Pakistan, Indonesia (Department of Education, 2023)



### TUITION FEES

UNDERGRAD → between 20.000 - 45.000 AUD/year  
POSTGRAD → between 22.000 - 50.000 AUD/year (Lungu, 2022)

Exists more than a 1000 scholarships (ScholarshipPoz, 2023)



Personal experience with coming to Australia...

- STUDENT VISA AUD 710
- OBLIGATED HEALTH CHECK AUD 588
- ONE WAY PLANE TICKET AUD 1910
- ENGLISH TEST AUD 441

→ TOTAL = AUD 3653 before even getting into the country...

- Must also provide the Department of Home Affairs that you have at least AUD 21.000 for living costs per year (Playdon, 2023)

Most international students are enrolled in undergraduate programs (Erudera, 2022)

## DOMESTIC

UNDERGRAD → between 15.000 - 33.000 AUD/year  
POSTGRAD → between 14.000 - 37.000 AUD/year (Study Adelaide, 2023)

Exists more than 3000 scholarships (The good universities guide)

## STUDENTS



4.042 512 STUDENTS IN AUSTRALIA → 11% INTERNATIONAL (ABS, 2022)

In 2019, international education was Australia's biggest services export \$41b

62% UNDERGRAD  
30% POSTGRAD (Universities Australia, 2022)

## PART-TIME JOBS

Retail & Hospitality (Study Australia, 2023)

MINIMUM WAGE 23,23 per hour (Fair Work Ombudsman, 2023)

The rising cost of living for

59,3% are 24 years or younger  
83,2% are supported by Universities Australia, 2023

## COMMONWEALTH EDUCATIONAL SUPPORT

- Higher Educational Loan Program
- HECS-HELP
- FEE-HELP
- Commonwealth supported places (Playdon, 2023)

Student contribution amounts vary depending on what you study, but are capped by the government (Playdon, 2023)

Students HECS-HELP loans are indexed annually with CPI but this year's hike carried a particularly painful sting for debt holders (Adenza, 2023)

STUDENT HOUSING ON VS OFF High demand Low supply (Savills, 2022)

Cheapest: Uni of Southern Queensland  
Most expensive: Uni of Melbourne (Playdon, 2023)

42 UNIS

DO THE MATH!!!



MONTHLY SPENDING 2835 average living cost for a student (Cost of Living calculator, 2023)

AVERAGE STUDENT LOAN 24.220  
TOTAL IN AUS. \$746 (Achenza, 2023)

HECS-DEBT from 2013 has now increased 10 TIMES (Achenza, 2023)

## COST OF LIVING: EXAMPLE

- Living in Sydney in the city
- Shared house
- Public transport: OFTEN
- Bicycle: SOMETIMES
- Uber: RARELY
- Eating out: ONCE A WEEK
- Cheap gym
- Moderate mobile plan
- Cinemas, live music, culture
- Groceries
- Health care
- Insurance
- Gas/electricity

43% of people between 20-24 live with their parents. More in than in

Study costs are largely subsidised by the government - available in all public universities (Playdon, 2023)

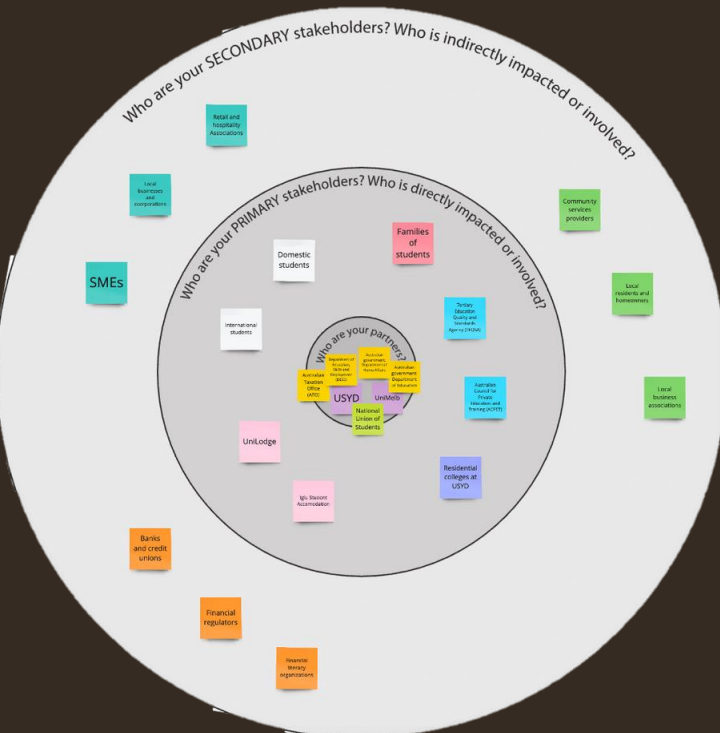
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# STAKEHOLDER MAP

SEE FULL MAP IN MIRO BOARD



[Click here to get to Miro-board](#)

## PARTNERS

My partners include organisations and institutions directly involved in education, finance, policy-making, and student support services. Collaborating with these entities will enhance my research's depth and impact.

### UNIVERSITIES AND EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

Partnering with universities allows me access to valuable insights and data from an academic perspective. They can provide information about student demographics, enrollment trends, and institutional policies.

### GOVERNMENT DEPARTMENTS AND AGENCIES

Collaborating with government bodies responsible for education and financial policies can help me gain a comprehensive understanding of regulations, funding mechanisms, and potential solutions to address the rising cost of living for students.

### STUDENT ORGANISATIONS AND ADVOCACY GROUPS

Engaging with student unions and advocacy groups can provide firsthand accounts of students' experiences and challenges. They can offer insights into the daily lives of students and their financial struggles.

## PRIMARY STAKEHOLDERS

The primary stakeholders are those directly affected by the issue and are interested in its outcomes.

### STUDENTS (DOMESTIC AND INTERNATIONAL)

Students are at the heart of my research. They experience the effects of rising living costs firsthand and their experiences and perspectives are crucial for understanding the issue.

### FAMILIES OF STUDENTS

Parents and family members of students often provide financial support and guidance. Their insights can shed light on the broader impact of rising costs on households.

### EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

Universities and colleges have a stake in understanding and addressing students' financial challenges. They may need to adapt their policies and support services to accommodate changing circumstances.

## SECONDARY STAKEHOLDERS

The secondary stakeholders may not be directly impacted, but they have an interest or influence in the matter.

### EMPLOYERS

Companies that employ students, particularly in part-time or casual roles, are indirectly affected by the students' financial situations. They might observe changes in employee availability or productivity.

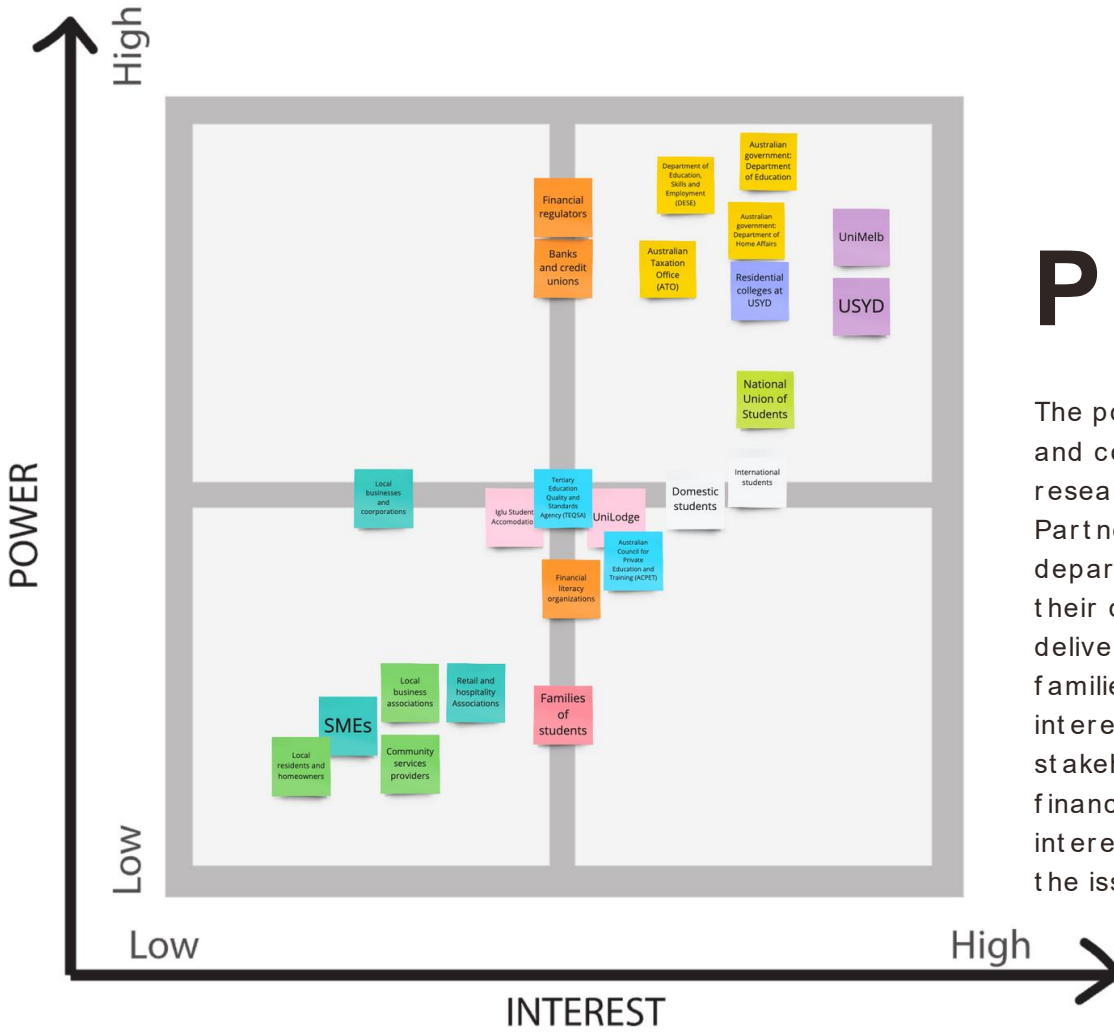
### LOCAL COMMUNITIES

Student spending patterns and demand for affordable housing impact communities surrounding universities. Changes in student financial situations could influence local economies.

### FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS

Banks, credit unions, and financial service providers have a stake in understanding the financial needs of students. They might offer products tailored to student customers.





# POWER MAP

The power map reflects the varying degrees of influence and concern held by different stakeholders in the research on rising living costs for students in Australia. Partners such as universities and government departments possess high power and interest due to their direct involvement in policy-making and educational delivery. Primary stakeholders, including students, families, and educational institutions, also exhibit high interest, though their power level differ. Secondary stakeholders like employers, local communities, and financial institutions demonstrate mixed power and interest levels, reflecting their indirect relationships with the issue.

# RESEARCH PLAN

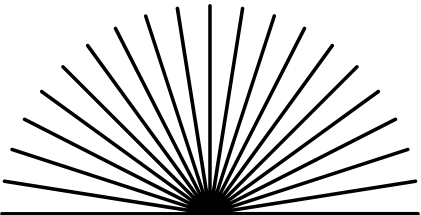


## Project area: Affordable and nutritious food access for students

As seen in my initial research, students find themselves particularly vulnerable to the impact of rising prices. Financial constraints do not only compromise their ability to meet basic needs but to extend essential aspects like securing nutritious food. In response to the escalating challenge of rising living costs for students in Australia, I will, therefore, further investigate the crucial issue of affordable and nutritious food access. The project aims to develop innovative solutions that relieve the financial strain on students while ensuring they have consistent access to wholesome and balanced meals. Solution spaces that can be investigated are the creation of digital platforms, community-centred initiatives, and on-campus hubs to connect students with cost-effective food options. By fostering collaborative partnerships with local eateries, government agencies, and student communities, the ultimate goal is to empower students with the means to make informed food choices, reduce food insecurity, and promote a healthier lifestyle. This project is driven by the conviction that students' well-being and academic success are closely linked to their ability to access nutritious meals within their budget constraints.

## POTENTIAL LIMITATIONS

The project may encounter challenges in ensuring the scalability and sustainability of the proposed solutions, especially if they heavily rely on external partnerships. Additionally, community-centred interventions may be influenced by students' willingness to actively engage. Moreover, the broader socio-economic factors contributing to students' financial constraints could present complexities beyond the scope of potential solutions.



# RESEARCH PLAN



## Target group

When choosing candidates for interviews, it's important to consider their qualifications and choose candidates willing to honestly and openly share information. Conducting the interviews somewhere the candidates feel comfortable can also help them be more open to sharing "their story" (Turner, 2010).

My project's target group is domestic and international students enrolled in higher education institutions across Australia. This group was chosen due to their significant representation within the student population and vulnerability to rising living costs. Despite government initiatives to subsidise education, domestic students still encounter rising living costs, resulting in an increase in student loan debts. International students face high tuition fees and often require proof of substantial funds. The focus on students is justified by their vulnerability to financial strain, particularly regarding basic necessities like nutritious food.

## Recruitment

The research participants will be recruited for interviews using a multistage approach, which involves two or more rounds of random sampling based on the hierarchical structure of inherent population clusters. Clusters are natural segments within the population (Sedgwick, 2015). The chosen recruitment method aligns with the project's goals by ensuring wide coverage and inclusivity.

Firstly, an initial invitation will be extended to students through university communication channels such as email newsletters, student forums, and social media platforms. This will ensure a diverse pool of potential participants from different backgrounds and experiences.

Additionally, convenience sampling will be employed to supplement the recruitment process. This method involves reaching out to students who may be easily accessible due to their proximity, such as those attending on-campus events or residing in student housing.

## Ethical considerations

Interviewing research participants introduces ethical concerns that need careful consideration. A potential hazard could be psychological discomfort or distress caused by participants sharing personal financial struggles. There is a risk that discussing sensitive topics related to rising living costs might evoke feelings of vulnerability or anxiety.

To mitigate this, a thorough plan will be implemented. Participants will receive clear information about the interview's purpose, voluntary nature, and their right to withdraw at any point without consequences. Before the interview, a consent form will be provided outlining the project's goals, potential risks, and confidentiality measures. During the interview, participants will be encouraged to share only what they are comfortable discussing, and any identifying information will be kept confidential. Furthermore, I will also explain how the participants can get in touch with me after the interview if they want to (Turner, 2010).

# 5 DRAFTED QUESTIONS FOR A SEMI-STRUCTURED INTERVIEW

01

How have rising living costs affected your access to affordable, nutritious food as a student?

02

Can you describe any specific challenges you've encountered to maintain a balanced and wholesome diet within your budget constraints?

03

Have you come across any existing resources, support systems, or initiatives that have positively impacted your food choices and well-being as a student?

04

In your view, what solutions could effectively alleviate the financial burden of accessing nutritious meals for students?

05

What type of information or assistance do you believe would be most valuable in promoting healthier eating habits within your budget?



Semi-structured interviews use a combination of fixed-script questions and open-ended questions, and have the benefit of both delving deeper into participants' responses and exploring interesting tangents in the conversation (Tomitsch et al., 2021).



# SOURCES

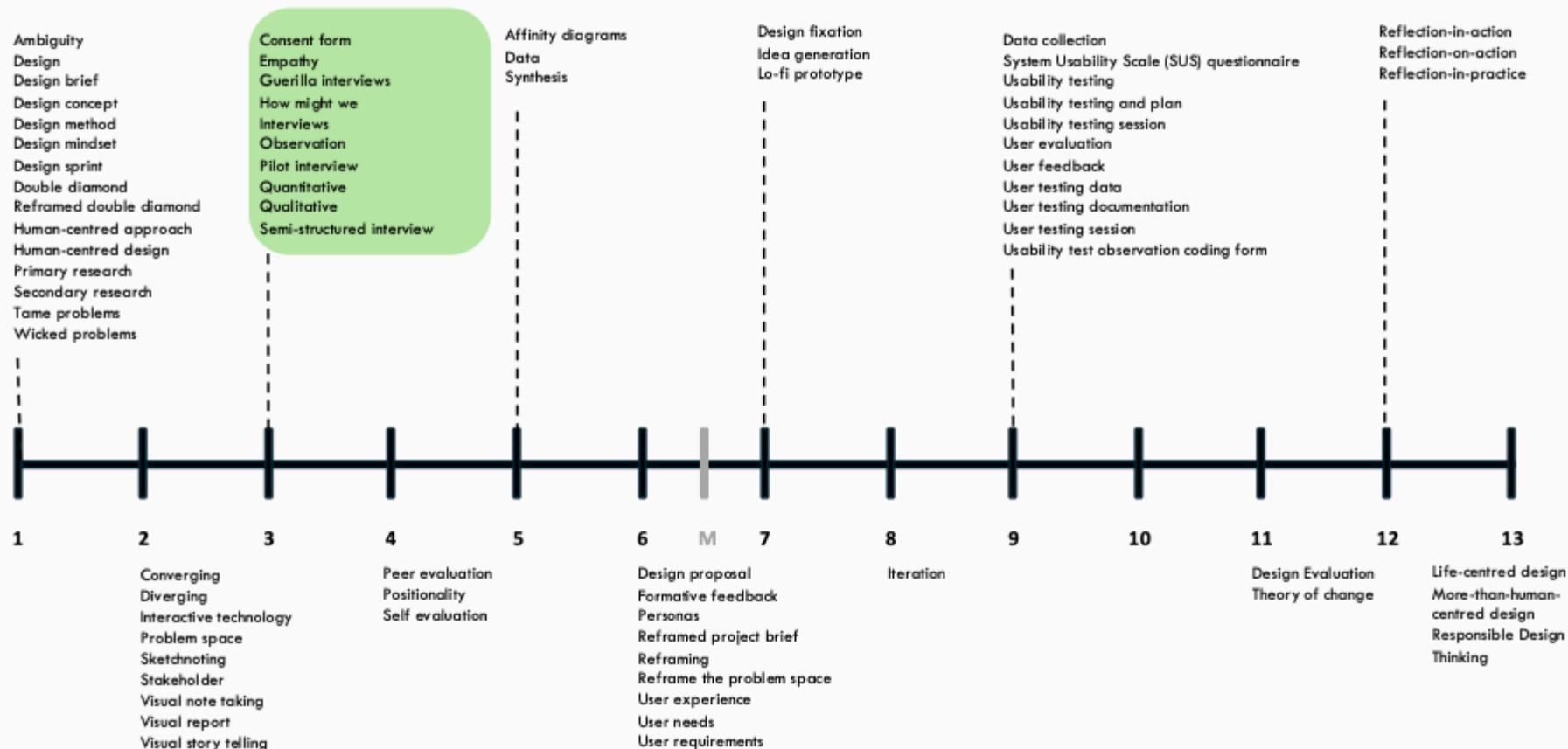
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# Overview: Week 3

- Design Thinking concepts & theory
- Design Thinking methods & practice
- A3 sample
- **Wrap Up**



## IDEA9106 Key Concepts: Week 3



# Reminders

- You must attend your timetabled tutorials
- Project teams to be registered on Canvas in tutorials this week
- A2a. Team Agreement is due tonight 18/08/2026
- Conduct one interview this week as a pilot to test your interview questions

That's the end of today's lecture.

We'll see you in tutorials.

Find your class location here:



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